

A FIELD GUIDE FOR FIRST-TIME RESELLERS

Buy Smart. Sell for Real Profit.

How to use Merch Radar to turn kedai runcit, Lazada, and wholesaler finds into a real eBay reselling business.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- The mindset that keeps you from buying dead stock
- Your two supply lines, matched to the right tool
- A 6-step workflow: Scout → HDLR → Trends → Sourcing → Manifest → Middleman
- How to read a verdict, a fee waterfall, and a risk flag
- One full worked example, start to finish
- A weekly routine so this becomes a habit, not a one-off

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A Note Before We Start

You're starting something new, and you're doing it the right way: by learning the tool before you spend a single ringgit. That already puts you ahead of most people who jump straight into buying stock on a hunch.

This guide walks you through Merch Radar — a free web app that answers one question over and over, in different ways: **"is this thing worth buying, at this price, right now?"** It doesn't guess. Every number you'll see is either pulled live from real eBay listings, or computed from a formula you can check by hand. Nothing here is hype.

Here's the honest part: this app tells you whether a specific buying decision makes financial sense. It doesn't run to the shop for you, it doesn't list your items, and it doesn't guarantee a sale. Reselling is real work — sourcing, listing, packing, shipping, handling returns. What this app does is make sure you're not doing all that work on something that was going to lose you money from the start. That alone will save you from the single most common way new resellers fail: buying stock nobody wants, at a price that leaves no room for profit once fees and shipping are paid.

How to use this guide

Read Sections 1–7 once, start to finish, before you buy anything. After that, keep Section 12 (the Quick Reference Card) open on your phone while you actually work — that's the only page you'll need day to day.

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The Mindset: Buyer, Not Gambler

Every tool in this guide exists to enforce one discipline: **never buy stock because it feels like a good idea — buy it because the numbers say so, and you can see the numbers.**

Four rules carry through everything that follows:

- **Proof before capital.** Don't buy something because you think it'll sell. Check whether it's already selling, to real buyers, at a real price — *then* buy.
- **Small bets first.** Your first ten purchases should be small enough that being wrong about one of them doesn't hurt. Confidence in your own judgement is built from a track record, not from a hunch.
- **The app never tells you to buy — it tells you what the numbers say.** You always make the final call, and you can always override it. But if the app says PASS, you need a very good reason to ignore that, and "I have a feeling" is not one.
- **A refusal to guess is a good sign, not a bug.** If a tool in this app says "not enough data" instead of making something up, that's the app protecting you. Hype tools always have an answer. Honest tools sometimes say "I don't know yet."

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One-Time Setup — Five Minutes, No Coding

Nothing to install. Merch Radar runs in your browser, on your phone or laptop.

1. Open **merch-radar.mhdazlan.cc** in your browser. Bookmark it — you'll be coming back to this often.
2. Look at the top-right corner for the **Demo Mode** switch. Leave it **OFF**. Off means every number you see is pulled from real, live eBay listings — which is what you want, since you're about to spend real money. (It only turns itself ON automatically if the live connection to eBay fails for a moment — you'll see an amber "DEMO DATA" badge on screen whenever that happens, so you always know which kind of number you're looking at.)
3. No account, no login, no payment details needed to use any of the tools in this guide. You're free to explore.
4. The menu across the top has seven tabs: Radar, Sourcing, Manifest, Middleman, Scout, HDLR, Trends. Don't worry about all of them at once — Section 5 gives you the order to actually use them in.

A note on currency

Merch Radar's numbers are in **US dollars**, because eBay's US marketplace is where the comps come from. When you're pricing a supplier quote from a kedai runcit or Lazada in ringgit, convert it to USD first (or use the **Middleman** tool in Step 6, which does the currency conversion for you).

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Your Two Supply Lines

You mentioned sourcing from your neighbourhood **kedai runcit** (and pasar/clearance racks), from **Lazada**, and from **wholesalers**. These aren't the same kind of buying, and Merch Radar has a different tool suited to each:

Where you're buying	What that buying looks like	Tool to use
Kedai runcit / pasar / clearance rack	One item (or a small handful) in front of you, right now. You can walk away.	Sourcing — check one item's margin before you pay
Lazada (single seller, small qty)	Buying a few units online to test, before committing to more.	Sourcing , same as above
Wholesaler / liquidation lot / pallet	A whole spreadsheet or invoice of 20–500 different line items, bought as one lot.	Manifest — scores every line at once
A supplier "friend" with flexible stock	Someone who can get you more of an item on request, in a foreign currency, not a one-shot pallet buy.	Middleman — margin + undercut pricing

In every case, before you even reach for one of those three tools, it's worth spending five minutes on **Scout** and **Trends** first — they help you decide *what* to go looking for at the kedai runcit or on Lazada in the first place, instead of wandering the aisles hoping something looks promising. That's the order the next section walks through.

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The 6-Step Workflow

This is the heart of the guide. Follow these steps in order the first few times — once it becomes second nature, you'll jump straight to whichever step fits the situation in front of you.

STEP 1

SCOUT · /scout

Find proof that something already sells

"Is anyone actually selling this?"

Before you buy anything, search for it in Scout. It searches eBay's **sold** listings — not "for sale," but items that real buyers already paid for — within the last 30/60/90 days.

Turn on the **seller feedback** filter and set it low (under 100). This is the single most useful trick in the whole app: if you find a seller with almost no feedback who's already selling the item, that proves the product sells itself — buyers don't need to trust a big, established seller to buy it. That's a door you can walk through too.

Scout also flags high-risk listings automatically — items priced suspiciously low (often counterfeit or scam bait), sellers with poor feedback, and titles containing words like "replica," "not authentic," or "for parts." Skip anything flagged.

TIP

Don't search for what you already own — search for categories you're curious about (e.g. "stainless steel tumbler", "kitchen storage") and let Scout show you what's already moving.

STEP 2

HDLR · /hdlr

Run the 5-gate qualification check

“Is this idea solid enough to spend real money on?”

HDLR takes a Scout-style search and checks it against five pass/fail gates before you commit capital: **demand** (enough monthly sales to matter), **new-seller** (low-feedback sellers are already succeeding), **risk** (no VeRO/brand-protection flags), **competition** (not so crowded, and not so empty it's suspicious), and **supplier** (you can actually name where you'd source it, at what cost).

The overall result is one of three words: **QUALIFIED**, **NEEDS EVIDENCE**, or **REJECT**. Treat REJECT as a hard no. NEEDS EVIDENCE means go find the missing piece (usually: get an actual supplier quote) before moving on.

TIP

This step exists specifically to stop you from getting excited about an idea in Scout and skipping straight to buying. Five minutes here can save you from a bad purchase.

STEP 3

TRENDS · /trends

Compare 2–5 shortlisted ideas side by side

“Of the few ideas I like, which one is actually the strongest?”

Type in up to five product ideas at once. Trends pulls real eBay market data for each: how many are currently listed, the price spread (cheapest to most expensive), which brands/colours/styles dominate, and what share of sellers are newcomers.

This is **not** a fake “trend score” — Merch Radar deliberately refuses to invent a 0–100 hype number, because no one (not eBay, not Google) publishes real search-volume data for free. Everything you see here is a real, named count you can verify yourself.

A crowded market (lots of active listings) isn't automatically bad — check the new-seller percentage. A busy category where 20%+ of sellers are newcomers means the door is still open.

TIP

Use this to break a tie between two or three ideas from Scout, not to fish for new ideas from nothing — Scout is better at that.

STEP 4

SOURCING · /sourcing

Check the exact margin on one specific item, at one specific cost

“If I buy this right now, at this price, do I actually make money?”

This is the tool you'll use most, standing in the kedai runcit or with a Lazada listing open. Enter the product, your **buy cost**, shipping cost, condition, and which platform you'll sell on (eBay, Amazon, Walmart, Mercari).

You'll get a verdict — STRONG BUY, BUY, CAUTION, or PASS — plus six numbers: estimated sell price, net profit, ROI %, sell-through rate, days to flip, and profit per day. Section 6 explains exactly how to read these.

Every fee eBay/Amazon/etc. will charge you is shown as a line-item breakdown, not buried in the final number. Section 7 covers this.

TIP

If the verdict changes when you switch the platform dropdown (eBay vs Amazon vs Walmart), that's the fee structure doing its job — some platforms simply pay better for certain items.

STEP 5

MANIFEST · /sourcing/manifest

Score an entire wholesale lot or liquidation pallet in one pass

“Of the 80 different items in this lot, which ones are actually worth the money?”

When a wholesaler sends you a spreadsheet or invoice listing many different items at once, don't evaluate them one by one in Sourcing — paste (or upload) the whole list into Manifest instead.

It automatically matches your column headers (item name, quantity, unit cost), then runs every single line through the same margin math and verdict engine as Sourcing — for free, with no waiting, because that part never touches AI.

You'll get one sortable table: every line ranked by ROI, profit per day, or total net profit, with dead-stock lines highlighted so you can see at a glance which parts of the lot are worth bidding on and which parts you should walk away from (or negotiate a lower price for the whole lot because of them).

At the very top, one summary line tells you the number that actually decides whether you buy the lot at all: total cost, projected net profit, blended ROI, and how many lines are dead-stock risks.

TIP

Export the results table before you decide — you can show it to whoever you're buying the pallet from as your basis for negotiating the price down.

STEP 6

MIDDLEMAN · /middleman

Price a flip when your supplier is a person, not a pallet

“My contact can get me more of this whenever I need it, at their price, in their currency — what should I sell it for?”

Use this when your supply comes from a flexible source — a factory contact, a friend who imports, a wholesaler you can re-order from — rather than a one-time lot. Dead-stock risk matters less here, because you can simply order less next time; the real fight is margin thickness after fees and international shipping.

Enter the supplier's price (in their currency), the FX rate, your shipping cost, and the current competitor prices on eBay for the same item. Middleman tells you the **undercut price** — exactly how far below the cheapest competitor you can price and still profit.

The competitor price ladder shows you the whole field, not just the lowest price, so you can decide whether to compete on price or sit higher with better presentation/service.

TIP

Re-check this whenever the FX rate moves. A margin that worked last month can quietly disappear if the ringgit moves against you.

Two more tools worth knowing about:

Shipping estimator

Built into Sourcing. Give it the item's weight and size and it calculates the real chargeable shipping cost (couriers bill by whichever is higher: actual or volumetric weight) — including live EasyParcel rates where available, so your margin math isn't guessing at shipping.

Radar

Built for print-on-demand/custom sellers, but useful if you ever branch into seasonal items — it tells you what to have listed and by when, around 30 major shopping events (Christmas, BFCM, Chinese New Year, Eid, etc.).

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Reading a Verdict Like a Pro

Every verdict in Sourcing and Manifest comes from a fixed, published rule — never a guess. Click “Why?” next to any verdict and it will show you exactly which rule fired and the numbers behind it.

Verdict	What it means	What to do
STRONG BUY	High margin, sells fast, healthy demand.	Buy with confidence — this is the shape of a good flip.
BUY	Solid margin and decent sell-through.	Good to buy, just not spectacular. Fine for building volume.
CAUTION	Thin margin, or a decent margin on a price that's falling.	Only buy small, and price to move quickly if you do.
PASS	Negative margin, dead-stock risk, or falling prices.	Walk away. This is the app doing its job.

The six numbers next to every verdict:

- **Est. sell price** — what similar items are actually selling for right now (median of recent sold prices).
- **Net profit** — what's left after every fee, ad cost, and shipping cost is subtracted from the sell price, minus your buy cost.
- **ROI %** — net profit as a percentage of what you spent (buy cost + shipping). This is the number to compare across different items.
- **Sell-through rate** — of everyone currently trying to sell this, what share actually sold recently. Low sell-through with a long queue means dead stock risk.
- **Days to flip** — roughly how long, at current sales speed, before your unit sells.
- **Profit per day** — net profit divided by days to flip. This is the number serious resellers actually optimize for: RM10 profit in 2 days beats RM30 profit in 40 days.

Confidence matters as much as the verdict

Every verdict also carries a confidence percentage. If it's based on fewer than 5 comparable sales, confidence is capped low and marked **LOW SAMPLE** — treat a low-confidence BUY with real caution, and never bet big money on it. A high-confidence CAUTION is more trustworthy than a low-confidence STRONG BUY.

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Every Fee, Before You Commit

The fee calculator in Sourcing isn't a footnote — it's the audit trail for your profit number. Click it open and you'll see the full waterfall:

**Sell price – platform fee – fixed order fee – ad spend – shipping cost – your
buy cost = Net profit**

eBay's cut isn't a flat number — it changes by category, and it changes over time. That's why every fee preset in the app shows its effective date and a link to the source. Don't assume last month's fee rate still applies; the calculator always uses the current one.

Switch the **platform** dropdown (eBay / Amazon FBM / Amazon FBA / Walmart / Mercari / Custom) and every number on screen — including the verdict — recalculates instantly. Use this to find out which marketplace actually pays best for a given item before you decide where to list it.

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Worked Example — Start to Finish

Here's a real style of walkthrough, using a product category that performs well on eBay (numbers are illustrative — always check live numbers for your actual item):

1 Scout

You search “stainless steel tumbler” in Scout, filter to sellers with under 100 feedback, and find several small sellers already moving 20+ units a month. Proof of demand: confirmed.

2 HDLR

You run the same search through HDLR. Demand gate: PASS (well above the minimum monthly sales). New-seller gate: PASS. Risk gate: PASS (no brand-protection flags on generic tumblers). Competition gate: PASS (a healthy number of competitors, not a monopoly and not an empty market). Supplier gate: NEEDS EVIDENCE — you haven't priced a supplier yet.

3 Sourcing local trip

You find a similar tumbler at your kedai runcit / on Lazada for RM28 (~USD 6.30). You enter that as your buy cost in Sourcing, along with an estimated shipping cost. The verdict comes back **BUY**, ROI 34%, sell-through 46%, confidence 78% (well above the 5-comp minimum). The supplier gate in HDLR is now satisfied too.

4 Trends (optional)

Before committing, you compare “stainless steel tumbler” against two other ideas you're considering. It's the strongest of the three on price spread and new-seller share, so you go with it.

5 Decision

Small first bet: you buy 5 units, not 50. You list them, watch how fast they move, and only reorder in bulk (using Manifest if it's a mixed wholesale lot next time) once you've proven it in your own hands, not just on screen.

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Red Flags to Never Ignore

Walk away, no exceptions

PASS verdict — negative margin, dead-stock risk, or falling prices. There is no version of “but I have a good feeling” that overrides this.

LOW SAMPLE warning — fewer than 5 comparable sales. Treat the verdict as a guess, not a fact, and buy small if you buy at all.

Scout risk flags — “replica,” “fake,” “not authentic,” “for parts,” or a price far below the going rate. These usually mean counterfeit, broken, or scam-bait listings — don't use them as your pricing benchmark.

HDLR risk gate fails (VeRO) — the brand actively enforces against resellers. Getting your listing pulled (or your account suspended) isn't worth the margin.

A forecast that refuses to draw a line — if the app says “not enough sold history to forecast,” that's not a bug, it's honesty. Treat the item as unmodeled and buy smaller than you otherwise would.

None of this is the app being overly cautious for no reason — every one of these signals exists because ignoring it is exactly how new resellers lose money on their first few purchases.

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Your Weekly Rhythm

Reselling becomes a business, not a hobby, when it runs on a routine instead of inspiration. A simple weekly loop:

Mon	Scout 3–5 new product ideas. Run the promising ones through HDLR.
Tue	Visit the kedai runcit / browse Lazada / check wholesaler lists with your shortlist in mind. Price-check anything interesting in Sourcing on the spot.
Wed–Thu	List anything you decided to buy. Track how fast it moves.
Fri	Review the week: which items sold fast (do it again, bigger), which sat (stop reordering those), which you passed on that you're glad you passed on.
Weekend	If you have a wholesale lot or pallet quote to evaluate, that's when Manifest earns its keep — give it the time it deserves rather than rushing a bulk decision on a weeknight.

11

Money Truths

A straight conversation, mentor to mentee:

- **This tool removes bad-math risk, not effort.** It won't pack a box or answer a buyer's message. The work is still the work.
- **Your first month is for learning your own hands, not maximizing profit.** Buy small, buy often, and pay attention to what actually happens versus what the app predicted. That gap teaches you things no app can.
- **Reinvest before you spend.** The fastest way to grow this is to put profit back into the next round of stock, especially once you find a category with a repeatable BUY/STRONG BUY pattern.
- **Margins move.** Fee rates change, FX rates move, competitors show up. Re-check an item in Sourcing before you reorder it — don't assume last month's numbers still hold.
- **Cash flow, not just profit, is what keeps a small business alive.** "Days to flip" and "profit per day" matter as much as the raw profit number — a slow sale ties up money you could have used elsewhere.

This app's own footer says it plainly, and it's worth repeating here: estimates are based on marketplace data and modeled projections — this is not financial advice, and comps should be verified before purchasing. Every tool in this guide is built to give you real information to make your own decision with. The decision, and the responsibility for it, is always yours.

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Quick Reference Card

Keep this page open on your phone while you work. It's the whole app in one table.

Tool	Question it answers	Use it when...
Scout — /scout	Is anyone already selling this?	Hunting for new product ideas
HDLR — /hdlr	Does this idea pass every safety check?	Before spending money on a Scout find
Trends — /trends	Which of my shortlisted ideas is strongest?	Choosing between 2–5 candidates
Sourcing — /sourcing	Does this exact item, at this exact cost, make money?	Standing at the kedai runcit / on a Lazada listing
Manifest — /sourcing/manifest	Which lines in this wholesale lot are worth buying?	Evaluating a bulk/pallet quote
Middleman — /middleman	What should I charge to profit and still undercut competitors?	Sourcing from a flexible supplier/contact
Radar — /radar	What should I list, and by when?	Planning around seasonal events

The order that matters most:



You've got the tool. You've got the two supply lines you already know well. The only thing left is to start small, trust the numbers over the hunch, and let the habit compound. Good luck — go find something worth buying.